



The TermiSoc Constitution

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1 Designation

1. The name of the Society or Standing Society shall be "TermiSoc: The University of Plymouth Computing Society" which shall herein be referred to as the "Society".
2. The Society may be referred to as "TermiSoc".
3. "University of Plymouth Students' Union" shall herein be referred to as "UPSU".

2 Objects of the Society

1. The objectives of the society are to:
 - (a) Provide web space and an e-mail service to our members.
 - (b) Provide technical help and a support service to our members.
 - (c) Give provision for our members and their guests to learn about computing and computer media subjects, including but not limited to GNU/Linux, Web technologies, Networking, Media, and Communications.

3 Membership

1. Normal Membership of the society shall be open to all members of UPSU, subject to:
 - (a) Specific exemptions as provided in the UPSU Constitution and Bylaws.
 - (b) The discretion of the TermiSoc Executive Committee where it is believed that admission to membership may result in the Society's disrepute. Such a decision is subject to appeal to UPSU.
2. Honorary membership:
 - (a) May be conferred on a member of the society who has made outstanding contributions to the society.
 - (b) Membership of the Society shall itself not be deemed to confirm membership of the UPSU or any of the privileges pertaining thereto.
 - (c) Request to become an Honorary Member is carried out by sending a written declaration of this desire to the Secretary.
 - (d) Honorary membership may only be conferred by a majority vote at a General Meeting of the society.
3. External Membership
 - (a) Staff of the University may become non-voting external members by subscribing to the usual conditions of honorary membership.
4. All members must sign a System Users Agreement and pay membership fees, which shall be agreed each year by the society committee. These fees shall be paid into the society's Union account.

5. Membership is to be renewed annually, and is subject to behaviour as per section 8. The committee should make a reasonable effort to contact owners of accounts needing to be renewed. Any accounts not paid for by the last week of October should be restricted, and removed from the system after two weeks. If the fees are paid, the account may be renewed as usual.

4 Officers

1. The Core officers of the society shall be
 - (a) President
 - (b) Secretary
 - (c) Treasurer
 - (d) Safety Officer
2. These shall make up the key members of the committee. The committee shall be elected annually at the Annual General Meeting.
3. Only the key members of the society may be the signatories, one of whom must be Treasurer.
4. The names and contact points of the committee must be logged with the sports and societies officer and kept up-to-date.
5. The Core officers are able to create and dissolve non-core positions as the need arises. All Core officers must agree these decisions.
6. UPSU members who are not Society members may participate in the activities of the Society but not hold office in the Society.
7. UPSU members who are not Society members do not get a Vote. Honorary members are also unable to vote.
8. Each member shall have one vote. The Chair, or nominee, shall have an additional deciding vote in the case of a hung decision.
9. Quorum for the Committee shall be half plus one of all Committee members.
10. The Committee shall be responsible for the running and the proper management of the Society. Upon election to office, its Officers will assume responsibility for all matters relevant to their elected post and Officer status, including all business undertaken by their respective predecessors.
11. If any vacancies occur in the membership of the Committee Core Officers during its term of office, they shall be filled as soon as is convenient.

5 Management and Meetings

1. The power of the management of the society is vested in the committee.
2. The committee will ensure that society policy and, where applicable, UPSU policies are carried out at all times.
3. The Annual General Meeting of the society will be February each year, the actual date of which shall be decided by the current committee, and must be advertised at least 14 days in advance.
4. The Annual General Meeting shall take the following format:
 - (a) Approval of the minutes of the last meeting
 - (b) Matters arising from the last minutes
 - (c) Report from the Chair
 - (d) Report from the Treasurer
 - (e) Technical Report from the Technical Officer or Secretary
 - (f) Other reports as required
 - (g) Motions and amendments to the Society Documentation
 - (h) Elections to Committee for the following year
 - (i) Any Other Business
5. Extraordinary General Meetings
 - (a) A general meeting may be called by the Society Executive Committee or 4 members of the Society.
 - (b) They shall notify the President of the business they want to discuss and the President must arrange a general meeting at the earliest convenient date, giving 7 days notice of the meeting and the business.
 - (c) The Executive Committee shall appoint a chairman for the meeting.
6. Non-Constitutional Business Meeting
 - (a) All who are associated with the work of the Society may attend.
 - (b) At least 7 days notice and a provisional agenda shall be given to each Member.
 - (c) The president or his/her delegate shall chair the meeting.
7. Procedure
 - (a) The Society President shall call a Committee meeting at the request of any two members of the Committee.
 - (b) Every Society Committee member shall be given at least 4 days' notice of an ordinary meeting.

- (c) In case of emergency, an emergency meeting may be held provided that reasonable notice has been given to every member of the Committee.
- (d) Quorum for an Annual General Meeting shall be one third of the total membership or 5 members; whichever is the greatest.
- (e) The only exception to the right of a member to attend and speak at Society meetings shall be when the meeting is discussing reserved business, in which case only voting members of the Society Committee may be present unless the committee decides otherwise.
- (f) Members of the Society Committee who are unable to attend may send a nominee on their behalf.

6 Management of Funds

1. All funds must be held with UPSU
2. No withdrawals may be made from accounts without the consent of two or more registered signatories, including the Treasurer.

7 Alterations of the Society Constitution

1. No change shall be made to the constitution that deviates from the main aim of the Society.
2. Sections 1, 2, 3, 4.3, 7, 9 and 10 may only be altered with the consent of a two thirds majority vote at a General Meeting and the consent of the UPSU Sports and Societies Association Committee.
3. Any other part of the Constitution may only be altered at a General Meeting when a two-thirds majority has been carried.

8 Behaviour

1. The society shall ensure that any member on a recognised society activity, or acting as a representative of the society always acts within the UPSU constitution, this constitution and laws or bylaws relating to the location where the society activity is taking place. Should any financial payments be imposed (i.e. a fine) for disregarding the above, this will be the responsibility of the individual member of the society and not that of UPSU or the society.
2. The society shall ensure that any member of the society using the society's equipment, or any service using the society's identity always acts within the UPSU constitution, the society's systems user's agreement, this constitution and within the UPSU Safe Space Policy. Should any financial payments be imposed (i.e. a fine) for disregarding the above this will be the responsibility of the individual member of the society and not that of UPSU or the society.

3. The society's disciplinary procedure for breaches of the above is as follows, where appropriate, depending on the severity of the breach:
 - (a) In the first instance the member is given an official written warning; this can take the form of either an e-mail or letter.
 - (b) In the second instance the member's access to the society's equipment and services will be restricted pending a formal hearing.
 - (c) If the incident is of greater severity, or warnings are unheeded the society reserves the right to ban the member.
 - (d) The member is able to appeal as outlined under section 3.1b.
4. Any member whose access to Society equipment or services is restricted or who is removed from a committee position as a result of disciplinary action, will be ineligible to hold a committee position in the future without a two thirds majority vote of the Committee.

9 Constitution of UPSU

1. This constitution is applicable only to the society and operates within the constitution of UPSU.

10 Financial Procedures

1. The society must abide by the relevant financial procedure of UPSU constitution Chapter P, Section 3.

11 Safety Policy Statements

1. The society must abide by the clubs and societies safety policy statement and must produce a System Users Agreement.